ENEL301 - Fundamentals of Engineering Economics and Management

Workshop 1.
Ethics workshop

UNIVERSITY OF CANTERBURY
Te Whare Wānanga o Waitaha
CHRISTCHURCH NEW ZEALAND

Introduction and revision of lecture content

Introduction to your tutors….

Ultimate goal: to make ethically sound decisions

1. Personal sense of right and wrong
2. **Understanding of ethical theories**
3. Systematic decision-making process

- **Deontology**
  - Rule-based
- **Consequentialism**
  - Ends-Based Thinking
  - Get the “best” outcome
- **Virtues-Based** Ethics
  - Based on virtues of “good”
  - e.g. be honest

Workshop Goal & Instructions

Today's goal: To compare engineering codes of ethics to uncover embedded ethical theories and cultural values.

Instructions:

- As a group, use the worksheet to critique the IEEE code of conduct (ethical theories, strengths, weaknesses, values). (15 minutes)
- Repeat for your second code of conduct after 10 minutes
- Be ready to answer the key questions (next slide); nominate one person (2 mins max)

Codes of conduct are available on LEARN ; you will receive a worksheet shortly

"Ethics" → Workshop content

Form your groups!

- Get yourselves into groups of 4!
- You will be allocated actual groups at random next week), this is just for today

- Introduce yourselves if needed

- Your lead tutor will now assign your group a letter, along with your individual worksheets
- Keep the worksheets after this workshop (they could come in handy later)

- Please avoid using Gen AI for this exercise – it won’t help you if you get a similar question on the exam

Workshop Goal & Instructions

Assigned letter	Codes
A	ASME vs IEEE
B	ACM vs IEEE
C	Engineering NZ vs IEEE
D	Engineers Australia vs IEEE

Key Questions to Answer

- What are the differences in assumptions that the two codes make about who the engineer serves?
- What are the major points of difference?
- What are the major points of similarity?

Workshop Goal & Instructions

Student runsheet

Use this worksheet to record your group's analysis of each code of conduct. Keep this document for your study notes.

Organisation 1	Organisation 2
What is the main purpose of this code?	
Which ethical theory is most evident? (rule-based, virtue ethics, consequentialism). Provide an example clause that aligns with the identified theory	
What are the strengths of this code?	
What are its weaknesses or ambiguities?	
Who is the code written for? Whose interests does it protect?	
How does this code address environmental, community, or cultural considerations?	
Are any values or cultural perspectives missing or underrepresented?	

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Find your group

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Student groups to report back…

Summary of similarities and differences

Additional questions for you to consider

- How might this code conflict with personal, team, or company values?
- How might you navigate conflicting codes of conduct?
- Were there any differences in theoretical basis (e.g. deontology, consequentialism, virtues)
- Are any values or cultural perspectives missing or underrepresented?
- How did the different codes address environmental, community, or cultural considerations?